ENVR2002D · CLASS 9

How Can Science Support Maritime Decarbonisation?

My journey from shipping to research, policy and implementation

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Today’s lecture has two parts

PART 1

How I ended up in shipping research

30–40 minutes

My shipping background, an unexpected PhD decision, my interest in computers and coding, and the research I do today.

Break between the two parts · Part 2 begins at 11:00

PART 2

How science supports maritime decarbonisation

40 minutes

How evidence helps us measure emissions, compare possible pathways, and move promising ideas towards implementation.

PART 1

How I ended up in shipping research

My journey through family, shipping, computers and one unexpected decision.

Shipping came before research.

My grandfather and father both worked at sea, so shipping had always felt personal to me.

I later studied **International Shipping Management**, followed by **Logistics and Environmental Policy**—first learning how the industry works, and then asking how it could change.

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

Family connection to shipping or early maritime study

A PhD was not my first choice.

After my Master's, I had accepted a supply-chain management position at **Huawei**.

I then applied for a short Research Assistant position, mainly to help pay for my flight home.

A ten-minute conversation with Prof. Alexis Lau changed the direction. The next day, I decided to pursue a PhD.

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

Huawei career plan, RA opening or the turning-point conversation

I simply enjoyed computer games and coding.

There was no deeper reason at the beginning: I liked spending time on a computer, playing games and writing code.

Research gave me a way to bring these interests into my daily work: working with data, building algorithms and solving difficult problems.

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

Computer games, coding or an early programming setup